

TWIST

1. Passage anchor

> “...not because it was action-packed or full of dramatic **twists**.”

Passage meaning

twist = an unexpected change in the direction of a story or situation

轉折；**反轉**；**意外發展**

Here, the speaker means the novel is not driven by lots of surprising plot changes.

Practice

1. The film has several unexpected **twists**.

這部電影有幾個出乎意料的**轉折**。

2. I liked the story even though it did not rely on shocking **twists**.

雖然故事沒有靠震撼的**反轉**來吸引人，我還是很喜歡。

Core meanings of TWIST

2. twist — turn something around

= turn something with a rotating movement

扭；**轉**；**擰**

Examples

1. **Twist the lid** to open the jar.

扭開蓋子把罐子打開。

2. She **twisted the handle** slowly.

她慢慢**轉動把手**。

This is the central physical verb sense.

3. twist something together

= turn strands, wires, etc. around each other

纏繞；**扭在一起**

Examples

1. **Twist the wires together**.
把電線**扭在一起**。
2. She **twisted the fabric** into a rope-like shape.
她把布料**扭成繩狀**。

Shape / bend

4. twist — bend into an unusual shape

= bend or turn something so it is no longer straight
扭曲；彎曲

Examples

1. The metal had **twisted** in the heat.
金屬受熱後**扭曲了**。
2. The branch was **twisted** by the wind.
樹枝被風吹得**彎曲變形**。

5. twisted — physically distorted

= bent or shaped irregularly
扭曲的；變形的

Examples

1. The road followed a **twisted** path through the hills.
道路沿著山間一條**蜿蜒扭曲的路線**延伸。
2. The frame was badly **twisted**.
框架嚴重**變形**。

Story / plot

6. twist — unexpected story development

= sudden or surprising change in a story

****情節轉折；劇情反轉****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The ending contains a major ****twist****.
結局有一個重大的****劇情反轉****。
2. The final ****twist**** changes how we understand the whole story.
最後的****轉折****改變了我們對整個故事的理解。

7. plot twist

= unexpected development that changes the direction or meaning of a story

****情節反轉；劇情轉折****

Examples

1. The ****plot twist**** surprised everyone.
那個****劇情反轉****令所有人驚訝。
2. The film depends too heavily on its final ****plot twist****.
這部電影太依賴最後的****情節反轉****。

Very high-value literary/media use.

Unexpected real-life development

8. twist — surprising change in a real situation

= unexpected development that changes how events unfold

****意外轉折；突發變化****

Examples

1. The case took an unexpected ****twist****.
案件出現了意外****轉折****。
2. In a strange ****twist****, the two rivals ended up working together.

在一個出乎意料的**轉折**下，兩個對手最後竟然合作了。

9. twist of fate

= unexpected event that changes someone's life or situation

命運的轉折；命運弄人

Examples

1. By a strange **twist of fate**, they met again years later.

因一次奇妙的**命運轉折**，他們多年後再次相遇。

2. A sudden **twist of fate** changed everything.

一次突如其來的**命運轉折**改變了一切。

Distort meaning / facts

10. twist — distort words or facts

= change the meaning of something unfairly or inaccurately

歪曲；曲解

Examples

1. Don't **twist my words**.

不要**曲解我的話**。

2. The report **twisted the facts**.

那份報告**歪曲了事實**。

Major figurative sense.

11. twist someone's words

= deliberately interpret or repeat someone's words in a misleading way

曲解某人的話

Examples

1. He accused the interviewer of **twisting his words**.

他指責訪問者**曲解他的話**。

2. She felt her comments had been **twisted**.
她覺得自己的言論被**歪曲了**。

Body injury

12. twist an ankle / knee

= injure a joint by turning it suddenly or unnaturally
扭傷腳踝 / 膝蓋

Examples

1. I **twisted my ankle** while running.
我跑步時**扭傷了腳踝**。
2. She **twisted her knee** on the stairs.
她在樓梯上**扭傷了膝蓋**。

Very common everyday sense.

13. twisted ankle

= ankle injured by sudden rotation
扭傷的腳踝

Examples

1. He rested because of a **twisted ankle**.
他因**腳踝扭傷**而休息。
2. A **twisted ankle** can become swollen quickly.
腳踝扭傷可能很快腫起來。

Body movement

14. twist — rotate the body

= turn part of the body around

****扭動；轉身****

Examples

1. She ****twisted around**** to look behind her.
她****扭過身****往後看。
2. He ****twisted his body**** to avoid the ball.
他****扭動身體****避開那顆球。

Facial expression

15. twist — contort face

= change the shape of the face because of pain, anger, disgust, etc.

****扭曲表情；使臉部變形****

Examples

1. His face ****twisted in pain****.
他的臉因疼痛而****扭曲****。
2. Her mouth ****twisted into a smile****.
她嘴角一****扭****，露出一個微笑。

Road / path

16. twist — curve repeatedly

= move or extend with many turns and bends

****蜿蜒；曲折****

Examples

1. The road ****twists through the mountains****.
道路在山間****蜿蜒而行****。
2. The river ****twisted across the valley****.
河流在山谷中****曲折流過****。

Noun: turn / curve

17. twist — turn or bend in shape/path

= a bend, curve, or turn

彎曲；轉彎

Examples

1. The road has several sharp **twists**.

這條路有幾個急**彎**。

2. The rope had a strange **twist** in it.

繩子有一處奇怪的**扭曲**。

Dance

18. the Twist

= dance popularized in the 1960s involving twisting the body

扭扭舞

Examples

1. They danced **the Twist**.

他們跳起了**扭扭舞**。

2. **The Twist** became extremely popular.

扭扭舞曾經非常流行。

Distinct cultural noun sense.

Flavor / variation

19. twist — unusual variation

= small change added to make something more interesting or different

新變化；別出心裁的變化

Examples

1. The chef gave the traditional dish a modern **twist**.

廚師為傳統菜式加入了現代**新意**。

2. The story is a familiar idea with an unusual **twist**.
這個故事是在熟悉概念上加入了不尋常的**變化**。

Very common figurative use.

20. with a twist

= with an unusual or unexpected variation

帶有新意；有所變化

Examples

1. It is a classic recipe **with a twist**.
這是一道加入新意的經典食譜。
2. The film is a romance **with a twist**.
這是一部帶有意外變化的愛情片。

Drink garnish

21. twist — strip of citrus peel

= thin spiral strip of lemon/orange peel added to a drink

檸檬 / 橙皮捲

Examples

1. Garnish the drink with a lemon **twist**.
用一條檸檬皮**捲**裝飾飲品。
2. The cocktail was served with an orange **twist**.
雞尾酒配上一條橙皮**捲**。

Established culinary/bar sense.

Pressure / coercion

22. twist someone's arm

= persuade or pressure someone into doing something

****勉強說服；施壓迫使****

Usually figurative.

Examples

1. I didn't want to go, but she ****twisted my arm****.
我本來不想去，但她****硬是說服了我****。
2. You don't have to ****twist my arm****—I'd love to come.
你不用****費力說服我****，我很樂意去。

Emotion / painful effect

23. twist the knife

= deliberately make an already painful situation worse

****在傷口上撒鹽；故意加深痛苦****

Examples

1. Mentioning his failure only ****twisted the knife****.
提到他的失敗只是在****傷口上撒鹽****。
2. She apologized instead of ****twisting the knife****.
她選擇道歉，而不是****進一步加深傷害****。

Related forms

24. twisted — morally disturbing / abnormal

= cruel, disturbing, perverse, or psychologically warped

****扭曲的；病態的****

Examples

1. The villain has a ****twisted sense of humor****.
反派有一種****扭曲的幽默感****。
2. It was a ****twisted**** plan.

那是一個**病態而扭曲的計畫**。

Distinct figurative adjective sense.

25. twisting

= turning, bending, or changing direction repeatedly

扭轉的；蜿蜒的

Examples

1. We followed a **twisting road**.

我們沿著一條**蜿蜒的道路**前進。

2. The branches formed **twisting shapes**.

樹枝形成各種**扭曲的形狀**。

26. twister

A. something/person that twists

扭轉物；扭動者

B. tornado, especially informal AmE

龍捲風

1. A powerful **twister** struck the area.

一場強烈的**龍捲風**襲擊了該地區。

This lexicalized meaning is common enough to recognize.

High-value expressions

27. twist and turn

A. literal

= repeatedly change direction

彎彎曲曲；不斷轉向

1. The road ****twists and turns**** through the hills.
道路在山間****蜿蜒曲折****。

B. figurative

= undergo many unexpected developments

****波折不斷；變化多端****

2. The investigation had many ****twists and turns****.
調查過程****波折不斷****。

28. twists and turns

= complicated or unexpected developments in a story, process, or situation

****曲折；波折；峰迴路轉****

Examples

1. The story is full of ****twists and turns****.
故事情節****峰迴路轉****。
2. Their relationship went through many ****twists and turns****.
他們的關係經歷了很多****波折****。

29. twist someone around your little finger

= have very strong influence or control over someone

****把某人玩弄於股掌之間****

Examples

1. She has him ****twisted around her little finger****.
她把他****玩弄於股掌之間****。
2. The child seems to have his grandfather ****wrapped/twisted around his little finger****.
那個孩子似乎把祖父****哄得團團轉****。

****wrapped around your little finger**** is more common.

Key contrasts

30. twist vs turn

****turn****

= general change in direction or rotation

****轉 ; 轉向****

****twist****

= often suggests rotation combined with bending, distortion, or force

****扭 ; 扭曲****

Compare:

> turn the key

> 轉動鑰匙

> twist the wire

> 扭動電線

31. twist vs bend

****bend****

= change from straight to curved

****彎曲****

****twist****

= rotate around an axis or distort by turning

****扭曲****

Something can be bent without being twisted.

32. twist vs plot twist

****twist****

= any unexpected development

****plot twist****

= specifically an unexpected change in a fictional storyline

In the passage, ****dramatic twists**** refers to ****plot twists****.

33. twist vs surprise

****surprise****

= unexpected event or feeling

****驚喜 / 意外****

****twist****

= unexpected development that changes the direction or interpretation of events

****轉折 / 反轉****

A twist is usually more structural than a simple surprise.

34. twist vs distort

****distort****

= alter something so it becomes inaccurate or unnatural

****歪曲 ; 扭曲****

****twist****

= can mean distort, especially words/facts, but is often more vivid and implies deliberate manipulation

Compare:

> distort the data

> 歪曲數據

> twist someone's words

> 曲解某人的話

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****twist**** is:

****turn something around its axis, often causing a change in shape or direction****

From this develop:

Physical action

twist a lid

→ **扭開蓋子**

Shape

twisted metal

→ **扭曲金屬**

Injury

twist an ankle

→ **扭傷腳踝**

Path

road twists

→ **道路蜿蜒**

Then metaphorically:

Passage

dramatic twist

→ **戲劇性轉折**

Situation

unexpected twist

→ **意外發展**

Fate

twist of fate

→ **命運轉折**

Meaning

twist the facts

→ **歪曲事實**

Variation

recipe with a twist

→ **加入新意的變化**

Pressure

twist someone's arm

→ **施壓說服**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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twist — rotate	以旋轉方式扭、轉、擰某物
twist together	把線、繩等互相纏繞 / 扭在一起
twist — distort shape	使物件變形、扭曲或彎曲
twisted — physical	因旋轉 / 受力而變形、扭曲的
twist — story development	故事中出乎意料、改變發展方向的轉折
plot twist	劇情 / 情節反轉
twist — real-life development	現實情況中出乎意料的變化 / 轉折
twist of fate	意外改變人生走向的命運轉折
twist — distort facts/words	歪曲、曲解原本的意思或事實
twist someone's words	故意把某人的話曲解成另一種意思
twist an ankle/knee	因突然扭轉關節而扭傷
twist — body movement	扭動身體 / 轉身
face twists in pain	臉因疼痛等而扭曲
road/river twists	道路 / 河流蜿蜒曲折
twist — bend/curve noun	路線或形狀中的彎曲 / 轉彎
the Twist	以扭動身體為特色的扭扭舞
twist — unusual variation	為熟悉事物加入的新變化 / 新意
with a twist	在原本形式上加入意外或新穎變化
twist — citrus peel	飲品中用作裝飾的螺旋狀柑橘皮
twist someone's arm	施壓或努力說服某人做某事
twist the knife	故意令已經痛苦的情況更加難受；在傷口上撒鹽
twisted — psychological/moral	心態、想法等扭曲、病態或令人不安的
twister — tornado	非正式：龍捲風
twists and turns — literal	彎彎曲曲、不斷轉向
twists and turns — figurative	故事 / 事情經歷許多意外轉折與波折

Passage recap

> “...not because it was action-packed or full of dramatic **twists**.”

Here:

****twists**** = ****unexpected developments that suddenly change the direction of the plot****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **情節轉折**

* **劇情反轉**

* **意外發展**

Natural contextual translation:

**我喜歡它並不是因為它充滿刺激情節或戲劇性的劇情反轉。 **

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

twist

= **an unexpected change or development that alters the direction of a story or situation**

轉折；反轉；意外發展

The key learner distinction is:

> **twist a lid**

> → 扭開蓋子

> **twist an ankle**

> → 扭傷腳踝

> **twist the facts**

> → 歪曲事實

> **plot twist**

> → 劇情反轉

> **recipe with a twist**

> → 加入新意的改良版本

So the passage uses the **story-development** branch, not the physical turning sense.